

# CGI PRODUCTION COST GUIDE 2026

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The complete pricing playbook for brands buying CGI. Real budgets, real timelines, no fluff. Used by marketing teams worldwide to plan production spend and avoid getting overcharged.

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**RYMPE** — CGI Production Studio · [rympe-studio.vercel.app](https://rympe-studio.vercel.app)

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# WHY CGI COSTS WHAT IT COSTS

Most brands are shocked when they first see a CGI quote. A 30-second commercial can run from \$3,000 to \$150,000 — and both numbers are correct depending on what's inside. Here's the production math behind the price.

## The Three Cost Drivers

### Complexity

Simple product spin vs. full environment with lighting, physics, characters. Each level multiplies render time and artist hours exponentially.

### Revisions

Every round of revisions at a late stage costs 3–5x more than catching the same issue in the brief. Studios price in 2 revision rounds by default.

### Delivery Format

A single 4K master vs. 12 resized social cuts vs. source files + project handoff. Source files alone can add 40% to a base quote.

## Typical Hour Rates (2026)

|                         |                 |                                |
|-------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------|
| Junior 3D Artist        | \$25–45/h       | Modeling, basic materials      |
| Mid-Level CG Generalist | \$55–85/h       | Lighting, shading, compositing |
| Senior Motion Designer  | \$90–140/h      | Art direction, complex rigs    |
| Studio Day Rate         | \$800–2,400/day | Full pipeline access           |

# HOW TO WRITE A BRIEF THAT WORKS

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A well-written brief is the single highest-ROI document you can produce. Studios give preferential pricing to briefs that show the client has done their homework. Here's what to include.

## 01 Project Context

What is this for? Launch video, evergreen brand asset, social campaign? Include the platform, audience, and the one emotion you want viewers to feel.

## 02 Reference Examples

Link 3–5 videos you like. Specify what you like about each — mood, camera movement, color grade, pacing. "Like" is not actionable; "I want the slow reveal at 0:23 of X video" is.

## 03 Technical Specs

Delivery format (1:1, 16:9, 9:16), resolution (4K/FHD), duration, frame rate. Do you need source files? ProRes masters? Subtitles? State it upfront.

## 04 Timeline & Budget Band

Share your go-live date and a budget range (even "under \$10K" helps). Studios with a timeline mismatch will tell you immediately rather than wasting both sides' time.

## 05 Decision Process

Who signs off? Is there a creative director above you? Are there brand guidelines we must follow? Legal approvals?

# RED FLAGS: SPOT OVERCHARGING

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40% of brands overpay for CGI production. Here are the warning signs that a studio is padding quotes or will deliver below expectations.

## Watch for these signals:

- ' No itemized breakdown — only a lump-sum "commercial production" fee
  - ' Can't show you a 3D WIP or grey-box render in the first week
  - ' Revision rounds are not defined upfront (endless revisions = hidden cost)
  - ' Portfolio shows only renders, never final deliverables in real context
  - ' Render cost is listed as "TBD" — always get a render estimate upfront
  - ' No contract clause for source file ownership (you may not own what you paid for)
  - ' Timeline is "flexible" — proper studios book 4–6 weeks out for complex work
  - ' Can't name the software they use or their render pipeline
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## Green Flags (Good Studios Do This)

- ' Send a detailed quote breakdown within 48 hours of a complete brief
- ' Proactively suggest budget optimizations without lowering quality
- ' Share WIP updates on a fixed weekly cadence, unrequested
- ' Own their render farm or have a clear cloud-render workflow

# NEGOTIATION TACTICS

CGI quotes are not fixed prices — they reflect assumptions. Change the assumptions, change the price. Here's how to negotiate without damaging the relationship.

|                                                                                                                                                |                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Bundle for Discount</b>                                                                                                                     | <b>\$8K !' \$5.5K on second project</b> |
| Committing to 2+ projects upfront reduces studio overhead. A second project in the same pipeline often costs 30–40% less than the first.       |                                         |
| <b>Limit Revision Rounds</b>                                                                                                                   | <b>S a v e s 1 5</b>                    |
| Agree to 1 revision round instead of 2. Requires better briefs but can cut 15–20% off quotes.                                                  |                                         |
| <b>Defer Source Files</b>                                                                                                                      | <b>S a v e s 1 0</b>                    |
| If you don't need the project source files immediately, defer delivery to post-launch. Studios can plan renders more efficiently.              |                                         |
| <b>Anchor Your Budget</b>                                                                                                                      | <b>Bett er o utc om es</b>              |
| "Our budget is \$X, what can we get?" is always better than "how much does this cost?" — it shifts the conversation to value, not itemization. |                                         |
| <b>Seasonal Timing</b>                                                                                                                         | <b>S a v e 1 0 –2 0 %</b>               |
| Studios are slow in January–February and July–August. Off-peak projects often carry 10–20% informal discounts.                                 |                                         |

# HIDDEN COSTS TO BUDGET FOR

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Most surprises in CGI production bills come from five categories that rarely appear in an initial quote. Always ask about these explicitly.

**Render Cost** 10–30% of quote

Cloud render farms charge per compute hour. A complex scene can cost \$400–2,000 in render alone. Ask if render is included.

**Sound Design & Music** \$500–3,000

Licensing a track or commissioning original sound adds up. Royalty-free libraries exist but premium sync licenses are expensive.

**Revision Overages** \$150–400/h

Revisions beyond the contracted rounds are billed hourly. Always clarify what constitutes a "revision" vs a new direction.

**Source File Handoff** 15–25% of quote

The working project files (C4D, Blender, AE) are often not included by default. You need these for future edits.

**Format Conversions** \$200–800

Delivering in 6 social formats instead of 1 master is additional work. Get a quote for every output you actually need.

**Rush Fees** 25–50% surcharge

Need it in 2 weeks instead of 4? Most studios charge 25–50% premium for compressed timelines.

# 2026 MARKET RATE CARDS

Average production budgets by project type and industry. Based on studio pricing across US, EU, and Eastern European markets.

## WEB3 / DeFi / DAO

|                          |                     |
|--------------------------|---------------------|
| 30-sec Token Launch Film | \$4,000 – \$18,000  |
| Platform Explainer (60s) | \$8,000 – \$35,000  |
| Full Brand CGI Package   | \$15,000 – \$60,000 |
| NFT Collection Promo     | \$3,000 – \$12,000  |

## SAAS / TECH PRODUCT

|                          |                    |
|--------------------------|--------------------|
| UI/UX 3D Animation (15s) | \$2,500 – \$9,000  |
| Product Demo Reel (30s)  | \$5,000 – \$20,000 |
| Conference Hero Loop     | \$3,500 – \$14,000 |

## CONSUMER / E-COMMERCE

|                            |                    |
|----------------------------|--------------------|
| Product Spin (single item) | \$999 – \$3,500    |
| Lifestyle CGI Campaign     | \$6,000 – \$25,000 |
| 360° Product Configurator  | \$8,000 – \$40,000 |

## Get a Quote for Your Project

Fill out the brief form at [rympe-studio.vercel.app](https://rympe-studio.vercel.app) — we respond within 48 hours with a production plan, recommended tier, and clear quote.

**RYMPE Studio** · CGI Production for Web3, NFT & Tech Brands

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